

FOCUS GROUP INTERVIEW PLAN

Submit One Per Group

Step 1: Opener/Participant Orientation

The goal of this phase is to make sure participants feel welcome and understand the purpose/rules of the interview. How will you address the following? Who will cover these items?

- A. Welcome - Welcome people, say hi, tell them what our company is about and who we are
- B. Reveal Commonality - You are all Purdue students and have likely eaten in the dining courts.
- C. Reveal Purpose - We are here to gain perspective from many students on the food/dining experience at the dining courts.
- D. Explain the Rules - see below

Which group member(s) will be responsible for the above items? **Marco**

Rules for Your Focus Group: Draft the rules for your focus group. Should participants raise their hands, speak out when they feel the need, wait to be called?

- 1. There are no right or wrong answers; we listen and we don't judge.
- 2. Speakers may raise their hand to speak or speak out loud, whichever helps them speak more comfortably.
- 3. Wait for others to finish speaking before you take your turn.
- 4. If you need clarification on a question, don't hesitate to ask the moderator.

Step 2: Introductory Questions

During this phase of the interview, you will ask questions that address your topic in a very general way. "How did you first hear about Pantene shampoo....?". "What other brands of shampoo have you heard of?" "How often do you buy shampoo?"

- 1. What was your first impression of the Purdue dining halls?
- 2. When you think about your overall experience with on-campus food, what's the first thing that comes to mind?
- 3. How would you describe your typical eating routine during the school week, and how often do you use on-campus dining?
- 4. Is there a specific dining hall that you prefer over others? Why?

Which group member will be responsible for the intro? **Phillip**

Step 3: Transition Question

In this phase of the interview you begin the transition to more detailed questions. For example, “Could you tell us more about...?” or “So far we’ve discussed....now let’s talk about.....”

1. So far we’ve discussed eating habits related to dining halls, so now let’s talk more about the actual food and dining experience.

Which group member will be responsible for the transition? **Phillip**

Step 4: Key Questions

In this phase, you should ask your most critical questions—the questions most closely related to your interview purpose. “Can you tell me about the consistency of this Pantene shampoo?” “What does the smell of this shampoo make you think of?”

1. Does any dining hall food make you feel at home?
2. Think back to a time when you had a great meal at a dining hall. What made you feel that way?
3. Think back to a time when you had a poor meal at a dining hall. What made you feel that way?
4. Can you describe the approach that you take to picking what food to put on your plate at the dining hall?
5. Do you feel like food items represent themselves well? (If an item says it is a taco, do you leave feeling like you just ate a taco?)
6. Does eating at a dining hall feel more like an activity you look forward to or more like a chore you have to do? (or a secret third thing?)
7. How do you usually feel physically after eating at a dining hall?
8. How do you usually feel emotionally after eating at a dining hall?
9. Do you feel like you are able to represent yourself with the food you eat at a dining hall?
10. Do you feel like a part of Purdue when you eat at a dining hall?

Which group member(s) will be responsible for asking the above questions? **Lizzy and Mark**

Step 5: Closing

This is the final phase of the interview. All discussion should be summarized and confirmed with participants. Always end with a clearinghouse and a thank you.

- A. Summarize information learned during the focus group with participants.
- B. Thank participants.
- C. Clearinghouse Question

What is your clearinghouse question? - Does anyone have any questions or concerns for us?

Which group member(s) will be responsible for closing the interview? **Marco**